

Here you will find a range of resources that can help with your due diligence process. This page will be updated as new resources become available.

We have developed the following optional guidance material to help you understand and meet your due diligence requirements under Australia's illegal logging laws.

This guidance material aligns with the legislation and the way we conduct compliance assessments, audits and issue Requirement to Give Information and Produce Documents notices. It is the only departmentally endorsed guidance material and you should exercise caution when relying on other guidance resources.

We welcome your feedback on the guidance material to help us enhance and update these resources. You can provide feedback via email to illegallogging@aff.gov.au.

Download

[Your responsibilities as an importer – fact sheet \(PDF 258 KB\)](#) [Your responsibilities as an importer – fact sheet \(DOCX 234 KB\)](#)

[Illegal logging Due Diligence Toolkit for Importers \(PDF 631 KB\)](#) [Illegal logging Due Diligence Toolkit for Importers \(DOCX 690 KB\)](#)

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

Country Specific Guidelines (CSGs) explain the laws used in other countries to regulate timber harvesting. They provide information to help you determine the risk of illegal logging for timber sourced from key markets. CSGs may provide examples of documents to look for when undertaking due diligence on regulated timber, timber products or raw logs imported from those countries. Each CSG is accompanied by a Quick Reference Guide, which provides a high-level overview of the CSG's content.

CSGs co-endorsed by the Australian Government and exporting countries are provided below. If a CSG for a particular country is not provided below, it either has not yet been developed or is no longer endorsed.

Prior to March 2025, our illegal logging laws provided a specific CSG risk assessment method for undertaking due diligence. This is no longer the case. The legislation now provides two risk assessment pathways: one for certified and one for non-certified timber, timber products and raw logs. From March 2025, you are still required to consider the content of relevant CSGs when undertaking your risk assessment for non-certified timber, timber products or raw logs.

CSG documents still reference the outdated legislation in the preambles. The process involved in updating these documents takes some time patience while we work with our international counterparts to address this.

Canada Country Specific Guideline

Document	File size Released	
Canada Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	647 KB	September 2014
Canada Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	99 KB	September 2014
Canada Country Specific Guideline PDF	1.1 MB	September 2014
Canada Country Specific Guideline DOC	1.5 MB	September 2014

Chile Country Specific Guideline

Document	File size Released	
Chile Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	694 KB	July 2020
Chile Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	581 KB	July 2020
Chile Country Specific Guideline PDF	1.1 MB	July 2020
Chile Country Specific Guideline DOCX	717 KB	July 2020

Finland Country Specific Guideline

Document	File size	Released	Revised
Finland Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	746 KB	September 2014	July 2020
Finland Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	709 KB	September 2014	July 2020
Finland Country Specific Guideline PDF	1.1 MB	September 2014	July 2020
Finland Country Specific Guideline DOC	860 KB	September 2014	July 2020

Indonesia Country Specific Guideline

Document	File size	Released	Revised
Indonesia Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	286 KB	October 2014	October 2018
Indonesia Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	3.1 MB	October 2014	October 2018
Indonesia Country Specific Guideline PDF	1.0 MB	October 2014	October 2018
Indonesia Country Specific Guideline DOC	3.3 MB		

October 2014	October 2018
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Italy Country Specific Guideline

Superseded document in effect until 12 August 2023 File size Released

Italy Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	658 KB	October 2014
Italy Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	218 KB	October 2014
Italy Country Specific Guideline PDF	947 KB	October 2014
Italy Country Specific Guideline DOC	345 KB	October 2014

Updated Document in effect as of 13 August 2023	File size	Released	Revised
Updated Italy Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	215 KB	October 2014	December 2022
Updated Italy Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	149 KB	October 2014	December 2022
Updated Italy Country Specific Guideline PDF	1.37 MB	October 2014	December 2022
Updated Italy Country Specific Guideline DOC	3.83 MB	October 2014	December 2022

Malaysia Country Specific Guideline

Malaysia's forestry and timber industry operates in three defined regions: Peninsular, Sabah and Sarawak. To assist importers, a Country Specific Guideline is available for each region. The Quick Reference Guide covers all three regions.

Document	File size	Released	Revised
Malaysia Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	568 KB	February 2015	July 2020
Malaysia Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	654 KB	February 2015	July 2020
Malaysia Country Specific Guideline – Peninsula PDF	2.3 MB	February 2015	July 2020
Malaysia Country Specific Guideline – Peninsula DOCX	2.9 MB	February 2015	July 2020
Country Specific Guideline – Sabah PDF	2.1 MB	February 2015	July 2020

Country Specific Guideline – Sabah DOCX	6.2 MB	February 2015	July 2020
Country Specific Guideline – Sarawak PDF	3.9 MB	February 2015	July 2020
Country Specific Guideline – Sarawak DOCX	6.7 MB	February 2015	July 2020

New Zealand Country Specific Guideline

Document	File size	Released	Revised
New Zealand Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	652 KB	October 2014	July 2020
New Zealand Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	604 KB	October 2014	July 2020
New Zealand Country Specific Guideline PDF	1.1 MB	October 2014	July 2020
New Zealand Country Specific Guideline DOCX	1.3 MB	October 2014	July 2020

Papua New Guinea

Document	File size	Released
Papua New Guinea Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	231 KB	March 2016
Papua New Guinea Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOC	7.7 MB	March 2016
Papua New Guinea Country Specific Guideline PDF	2.0 MB	March 2016
Papua New Guinea Country Specific Guideline DOC	7.0 MB	March 2016

Republic of Korea

Document	File size	Released
Republic of Korea Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	1.7 MB	June 2018
Republic of Korea Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	3.2 MB	June 2018
Republic of Korea Country Specific Guideline PDF	374 KB	June 2018
Republic of Korea Country Specific Guideline DOCX	848 KB	June 2018

Thailand

Document	File size	Released
Thailand Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide PDF	3,616 KB	December 2021

Thailand Country Specific Guideline – Quick Reference Guide DOCX	6,196 KB	December 2021
Thailand Country Specific Guideline PDF	265 KB	December 2021
Thailand Country Specific Guideline DOCX	146 KB	December 2021

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#).

A number of third parties have published material and developed online tools that can be used to inform your due diligence process. We have included a selection, which is not exhaustive, below.

How you use these resources is up to you. However, you need to be aware that you cannot rely on a third party risk assessment to satisfy your due diligence obligations. You still need to undertake your own [due diligence process](#).

If you do use these resources, you should be aware that the information on these websites represents the views of a third party and may not be accurate, up to date, or relevant to your due diligence process.

If you have questions about the information in these resources, you should contact the publisher directly.

Disclaimer:

This content has been prepared to assist timber product importers understand, implement and comply with the requirements of the Illegal Logging Prohibition Act 2012 and the Illegal Logging Prohibition Rules 2024 with respect of their due diligence obligations. It does not constitute legal advice. Timber product importers may elect to seek their own legal advice in relation to the legislation and related matters.

All third-party materials provided on this webpage are intended to be a guide only, and the Australian Government is unable to warrant its currentness, accuracy, completeness or suitability for any purpose. These materials may be subject to further change.

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Certification schemes

These resources may assist with the Certified Pathway risk assessment method which relies on forest certification standards as defined in s 4 of the Illegal Logging Prohibition Rules 2024.

[Forest Stewardship Council \(FSC\) – Public Search Database](#)

The FSC maintains a database with information about certificate holders, logo and label users, certified products, and so on. This information can be used to help verify FSC certification claims.

[FSC – Forest Management Certification Standard](#)

The FSC has a forest management certification standard. Their website sets out the principles, criteria

and indicators that a forest operation must adhere to before receiving an FSC forest management certification.

[FSC - Chain of Custody Standard](#)

The FSC provides a chain of custody certification. Their website includes information on the core requirements behind this standard.

[Programme for the Endorsement of Forest Certification \(PEFC\) – Public Search Database](#)

The PEFC maintains a database with relevant information about certificate holders, logo and label users, certified products, and so on. This information can be used to help verify PEFC certification claims.

[PEFC – Sustainable Forest Management Standard](#)

The PEFC provides a sustainable forest management standard. Their website sets out the benchmark requirements that must be met to be endorsed by PEFC.

[PEFC – Chain of Custody Standard](#)

The PEFC provides a chain of custody standard. Their website lays out the requirements and conditions a company must meet for chain of custody certification.

Timber legality

[Chatham House – Illegal Logging Portal](#)

The Illegal Logging Portal provides information on the trade in illegal timber. This includes an overview of emerging issues and developments, reports, and a searchable database of global news articles.

[Forest Trends – Illegal Deforestation and Associated Trade \(IDAT\) Risk Tool](#)

Forest Trends provides a series of tools to support the national risk assessments when sourcing timber products. The IDAT risk tool includes country risk ratings and information about specific risks associated with illegal timber entering international supply chains.

[Preferred By Nature – Timber sourcing hub](#)

Preferred by Nature's timber sourcing hub includes national timber legality risk assessments with information on the risks associated with a particular country, and advice on mitigating actions.

[Forest Legality Alliance – Forest Products Risk Tool](#)

The Forest Legality Alliance website provides resources to help businesses source legal timber products. This includes a listing of current logging and export bans; country and species-specific risk information; and a sustainable procurement guide.

[TimberLex – Country Specific Legal Information](#)

The TimberLex database provides country-specific legal information on forest management, timber production and trade.

[FSC – Risk Assessment Tool](#)

The FSC's Risk Assessment Platform provides an overview of the FSC national risk assessments. The

platform includes summaries of the risk descriptions and control measures in the original risk assessments.

[European Timber Trade Federation – Timber Trade Portal](#)

The Timber Trade Portal includes country profiles outlining timber trade; forestry frameworks; relevant documents; and key points of contact.

[APEC Experts Group on Illegal Logging and Associated Trade \(EGILAT\) – Country Timber Legality Templates](#)

In 2014, APEC EGILAT member economies agreed to develop legality guidance documents. These legality templates seek to provide clarity on what constitutes legal and illegally logged timber within individual APEC member economies.

[World Wildlife Fund \(WWF\) Wood Risk Tool](#)

Launched in 2023, the WWF wood risk tool (the tool) aims to help companies and other wood buyers and regulators to assess, understand, and manage risks associated with logging and trade, and contribute to a more sustainable future. The tool provides consolidated information from a range of sources to provide information on origin and species risk.

Mapping – Illegal logging, deforestation and armed conflict

[World Resources Institute – Global Forest Watch](#)

The Global Forest Watch website hosts geographical datasets that can be used to analyse and identify illegal logging, including forest change, forest cover and forest use data. The site has concession maps (including names of licensees) for logging and plantation concessions in many countries.

[Forest Link – Mapping of Illegal Logging Reports](#)

Forest Link is an initiative which maps community alerts of illegal forest activities and information from in-country investigations.

[Crisis Group – Crisis Watch Conflict Tracker](#)

Crisis Watch is a global conflict tracker. The tracker is updated monthly with summaries of political and security developments in crisis areas and vulnerable countries.

[The Rule of Law in Armed Conflicts Project \(RULAC\) – Armed Conflict Map](#)

The RULAC project maps all major active armed conflicts across the globe, providing succinct information on each conflict.

Corruption and governance

[Transparency International – Corruption Perception Index](#)

The Corruption Perception Index (CPI) ranks countries by their perceived levels of public sector corruption. A low CPI ranking (less than 50) could suggest that a country's forestry governance arrangements are vulnerable to illegal logging.

[World Bank - Worldwide Governance Indicators](#)

The Worldwide Governance Indicators report governance indicators for over 200 countries looking at several aspects of governance including control of corruption, regulatory quality and government effectiveness.

Endangered Species

[International Union for Conservation of Nature – Redlist of Threatened Species](#)

The IUCN Redlist of Threatened Species lists plants and animals that are facing a high risk of global extinction. This includes information on geographical ranges and potential vulnerability to illegal logging.

[Convention on the International Trade of Endangered Species – Appendices I, II and III](#)

The Convention on the International Trade of Endangered Species (CITES) aims to ensure that international trade in specimens of wild animals and plants does not threaten the survival of the species. Species at risk because of trade are listed in the Appendices.

[Australia Government – Trading in endangered species](#)

The Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (DCCEEW)'s website provides advice on the regulatory requirements associated with trading in endangered species, including timber species.

Media and NGO Reports

[Environmental Investigation Agency \(EIA\) – International](#)

The EIA website provides information on recent forest reports and forest news, including deforestation, illegal logging and timber trafficking issues.

[Global Witness](#)

Global Witness is an international NGO investigating environmental and human rights abuses. Global Witness investigations and articles found here may help you stay on top of emerging issues.

[WWF - Forests Forward](#)

WWF's Forests Forward website focusses on WWF's work in forestry and plantations. Forests Forward highlights the areas of action for WWF in forestry. The Newsroom provides information on key issues in global forestry.

[Mongabay – Illegal logging news](#)

Mongabay is a non-profit conservation news platform. The illegal logging news page may help you stay aware of emerging issues.

Other resources

[Global Timber Tracking Network \(GTTN\) - Service Provider Directory](#)

GTTN's Service Provider Directory provides a system to help anyone seeking wood identification services to find information on scientific methods and available laboratories.

[SPOTT Assessment Score](#)

SPOTT is an online platform assessing commodity producers, processors and traders on their public disclosure regarding their practices related to environmental, social and governance issues. SPOTT considers palm oil, timber and pulp, and natural rubber.

[Open Timber Portal – Producer Transparency Rating](#)

The World Resources Institute’s Open Timber Portal focuses on the Congo Basin and uses a range of information to calculate a transparency score for each producer.

[Preferred by Nature – Guide to identifying fake documents](#)

This guide includes examples of forged documents, ways of distinguishing between genuine and fake documents, and advice on what to do if you encounter fake documents.

[APEC EGILAT - Compendium of Resources](#)

APEC EGILAT compiled ‘The Compendium of Resources for the Facilitation of the Trade and Distribution of Legally Harvested Forest Products in the APEC Region.’ The Compendium identifies and organises a range of resources, similar to some of those listed here, that aims to facilitate the trade in legal forest products.

[Plants of the World Online \(POWO\) – Seed-bearing plant data](#)

POWO is an international collaborative programme that can provide information on the distribution of all known seed-bearing plants worldwide. The database contains information on taxonomy, identification, distribution (including detailed maps), descriptions, images, traits, threat status (e.g., IUCN Red List data), and uses of plants.

[GlobalTreeSearch – Tree species distribution](#)

GlobalTreeSearch is a database of all the world’s known tree species and their country level distributions.

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Illegal logging reporting

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Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/forestry/policies/illegal-logging/importers/resources>